Employee Handbook (United Kingdom)

Version 5.1 - Effective 6 January 2025

Owner: People Team (HR)

1. Welcome to Kitewing

Kitewing Software builds scheduling and route-planning tools for mid-sized delivery companies. This handbook explains the policies that apply to employees of Kitewing Software Ltd in the United Kingdom. Employees of Kitewing Software Inc. in the United States should read their own edition of this handbook instead.

If anything in this handbook is unclear, ask your manager or contact the People Team at people-uk@kitewing.example. Where this handbook and your employment contract differ, your contract applies.

2. Working at Kitewing

2.1 Employment status

Your employment with Kitewing Software Ltd is governed by your written contract of employment. After your probationary period, either you or Kitewing must give one month's written notice to end the employment relationship, unless your contract says otherwise. Nothing in this handbook replaces your contract of employment.

2.2 Probation

New employees complete a six-month probationary period. Your manager will hold a check-in with you after 30 days and a formal review at the end of the six months.

2.3 Working hours

Our standard full-time schedule is 37.5 hours per week. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 UK time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours you may arrange your working day with your manager. Overtime must be approved in advance and recorded in PeopleHub.

2.4 Hybrid and remote work

Most roles at Kitewing are hybrid. The rules for anchor days, fully remote working and working from another country are set out in the Remote Work Policy on The Perch.

2.5 Pay

You are paid monthly, on the 25th of each month or the previous working day, by bank transfer. Payslips are available in PeopleHub. If you think there is a mistake in your pay, report it to payroll-uk@kitewing.example within 30 days so that it can be corrected in the next pay run.

2.6 Performance reviews

Kitewing holds performance reviews twice a year, in April and October. Before each review you complete a short self-assessment in PeopleHub, and your manager gathers feedback from two or three colleagues you work closely with. Ratings are calibrated across each department so that they are applied consistently. Pay increases and promotions are decided once a year, after the April review.

2.7 Learning and development

Every employee has a learning budget of £1,200 per holiday year for courses, books, certifications and conference tickets. Request learning spend in PeopleHub Learning before you book; your manager approves it. Unused budget does not carry over to the next year. If Kitewing pays more than £2,500 for a single course or certification and you leave within 12 months of completing it, you may be asked to repay part of the cost.

2.8 Business expenses

Business travel and other work expenses are covered by the Travel and Expense Policy on The Perch. Always check the current version of that policy before you book travel.

3. Time Off

3.1 Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per holiday year, plus the 8 UK bank holidays. Annual leave accrues at 2.08 days per month and is prorated for part-time employees and for anyone who joins part-way through the year. Annual leave is used for holidays and personal time.

3.2 Requesting annual leave

Request annual leave in PeopleHub. For absences of three or more consecutive working days, submit your request at least two weeks in advance. Your manager will approve or decline the request within three working days. Requests for more than 10 consecutive working days also need approval from your department head.

3.3 Carrying over unused leave

You may carry over up to 5 unused days of annual leave into the next holiday year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March or they are forfeited. Untaken statutory leave is paid when you leave Kitewing.

3.4 Bank holidays

Kitewing observes the 8 bank holidays for England and Wales. If you are asked to work on a bank holiday, you will receive a day off in lieu.

3.5 Sick leave

You receive Statutory Sick Pay where you are eligible, plus company sick pay at full pay for up to 10 working days in any rolling 12-month period. You can self-certify absences of up to 7 calendar days. For longer absences, you must provide a fit note from your GP.

3.6 Bereavement leave

If someone close to you dies, you can take up to 5 days of paid bereavement leave for an immediate family member (a partner, child, parent or sibling) and up to 2 days for other relatives. Tell your manager as soon as you can; you do not need to provide evidence. If you need more time, talk to your manager or the People Team about using other leave.

3.7 Jury service

If you are called for jury service, Kitewing pays your full base pay for up to 10 working days, minus any loss-of-earnings allowance you claim from the court. Give your manager a copy of the summons as soon as you receive it, and record the days in PeopleHub as Jury Service.

3.8 Carer's leave and unpaid leave

If someone who depends on you has a long-term care need, you can take up to 1 week of unpaid carer's leave every 12 months, in full or half days. With your manager's approval, you can also take up to 4 weeks of other unpaid leave in a holiday year, once you have used your annual leave.

3.9 Sabbatical

After 5 years of continuous service, you can take a paid sabbatical of 4 weeks, in addition to your normal leave. The sabbatical must be taken within 2 years of becoming eligible, and agreed with your manager at least 3 months in advance.

4. Parental Leave

4.1 Purpose

Kitewing supports employees who are welcoming a new child into their family through birth, adoption, foster placement or surrogacy. This section explains who is eligible, how much leave is available, and how to apply.

4.2 Eligibility

To be eligible for enhanced parental pay, you must have completed at least 26 weeks of continuous service with Kitewing by the end of the 15th week before the expected week of childbirth, or by the week you are matched with a child for adoption. You must also be a permanent employee; part-time employees are eligible on a pro rata basis. Birth parents, non-birth parents, adoptive parents and parents through surrogacy are all eligible. Contractors, interns and agency workers are not eligible for enhanced parental pay, but may be entitled to statutory pay.

4.3 How much leave you receive

Primary caregivers can take up to 52 weeks of parental leave. The first 26 weeks are paid: 16 weeks at 100% of base pay, followed by 10 weeks at the statutory rate. Secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks of paid parental leave at 100% of base pay. The primary caregiver is the parent with the main day-to-day responsibility for the child during the leave period. Eligible parents may instead choose to share leave and pay through Shared Parental Leave.

4.4 Pay and benefits during leave

Your private medical insurance and life assurance continue during parental leave on the same terms as when you are working. Kitewing continues to make employer pension contributions throughout paid parental leave. Annual leave continues to accrue during all parental leave. Annual bonuses are prorated for the time you spend on leave.

4.5 How parental leave works with statutory pay

Enhanced parental pay includes any Statutory Maternity Pay, Statutory Adoption Pay or Statutory Paternity Pay you are entitled to. It is not paid in addition to statutory pay. If you do not qualify for enhanced pay, you may still qualify for statutory pay, and the People Team will explain your options.

4.6 Returning to work

When you return, you will be placed in the same role or an equivalent role with the same pay. Returning parents may use a phased return: for up to four weeks you can work 60% of your normal schedule while receiving full pay. Agree the phased-return schedule with your manager before your leave ends.

4.7 How to apply

Submit a parental leave request in PeopleHub under Time Off > Leave of Absence > Parental Leave no later than the end of the 15th week before the expected week of childbirth. For adoption, submit the request within 7 days of being matched with a child. Attach your MATB1 certificate or your matching certificate. Your HR Business Partner will confirm your leave dates and pay in writing within 28 days. You should also tell your manager about your plans as early as you feel comfortable, so that cover can be arranged.

5. Conduct and Raising Concerns

5.1 Code of conduct

We expect everyone at Kitewing to treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect, to act honestly, and to protect company and customer information. The full Code of Conduct is on The Perch and must be acknowledged within 30 days of joining.

5.2 Reporting concerns

If you see something that concerns you, speak to your manager or the People Team. You can also report concerns anonymously through the Ethics Line on 0808 157 0192 or at ethics@kitewing.example. Kitewing does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

5.3 Equipment and information security

Follow the Information Security Policy at all times. If your laptop or phone is lost or stolen, report it immediately using Form IT-412 in the KiteDesk portal.

5.4 Equal opportunity and anti-harassment

Kitewing is an equal opportunity employer. We make decisions about hiring, pay, promotion and development based on skills and performance, never on race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, age, disability, or any other protected characteristic. Harassment and bullying are not tolerated. If you experience or witness harassment, report it to your manager, the People Team or the Ethics Line.

5.5 Dress code

There is no formal dress code. Dress appropriately for your day: smart casual is usual in the office, and business attire may be expected when you meet customers.

5.6 Social media

You are welcome to talk about working at Kitewing on social media, but you must not share Confidential information, speak on behalf of the company without approval from the Communications team, or post anything that harasses colleagues.

6. Health and Safety

Report every accident, injury or near miss to your office manager on the same day, even if nobody was hurt, and make sure it is recorded in the office accident book. Each office has trained first aiders, listed by the kitchen. If you work from home, complete the home workstation assessment in PeopleHub within your first month.

7. Leaving Kitewing

After your probationary period, we ask for one month's written notice if you decide to leave Kitewing (one week during probation). Your final pay, including payment for any untaken annual leave, is paid on the next regular payday. Return your laptop and any other equipment within five working days of your last day.

8. Key Contacts

People Team (HR): people-uk@kitewing.example

Payroll: payroll-uk@kitewing.example

IT Helpdesk: extension 4357 or the KiteDesk portal